



Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437 respondents · 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024 | For engineering managers & HR leaders

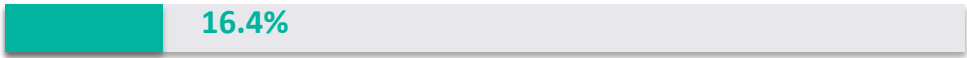
84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global Employment Breakdown

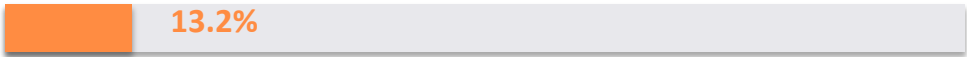
Full-time employed



Independent / freelance



Full-time students



U.S. Full-Time Employment: Year-over-Year

2023



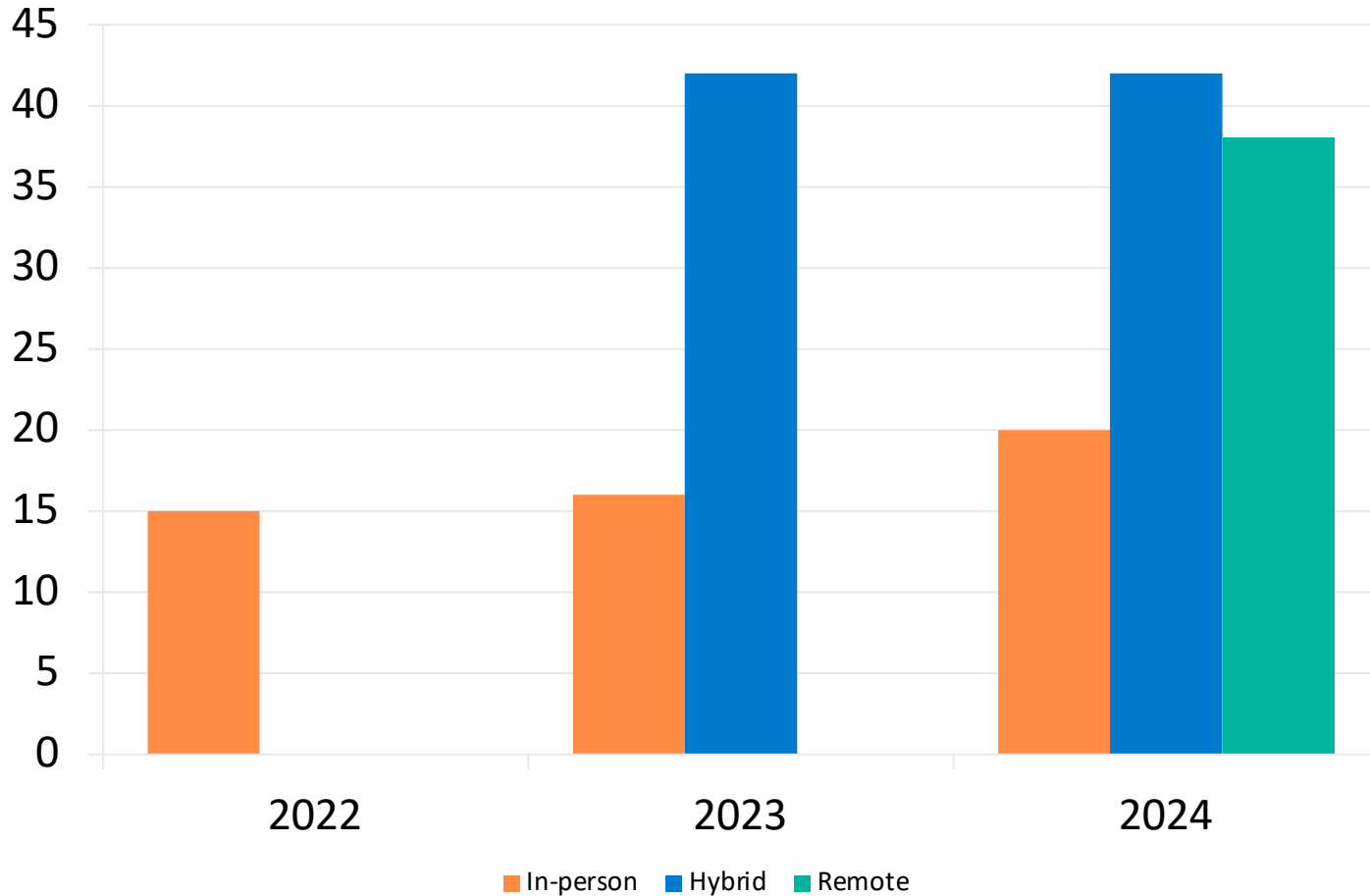
2024



↓ 4.2 pp drop year-over-year
U.K. & Ukraine lean freelance; Germany & India lean student

84% of 65,437 respondents are currently employed — but the mix is shifting toward freelance and contract work.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



2024 Snapshot

42% Hybrid

Most common arrangement, steady YoY

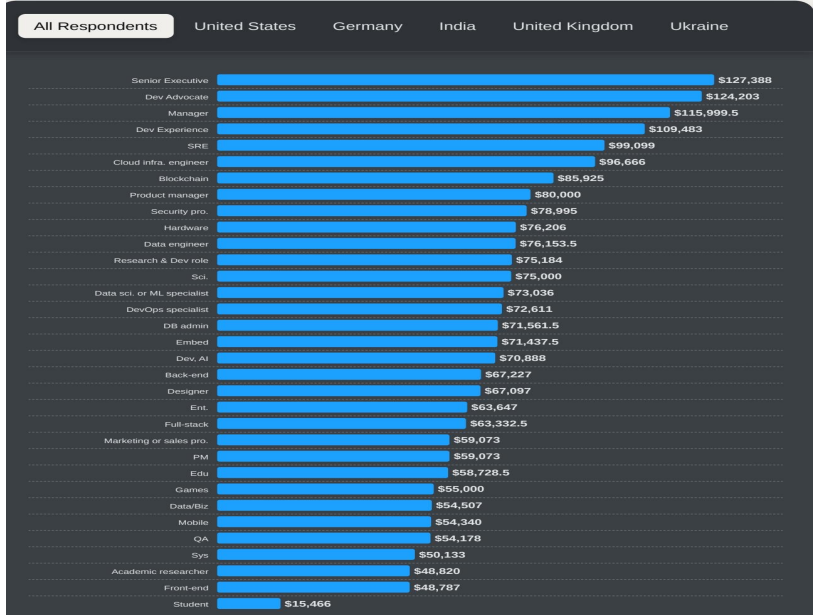
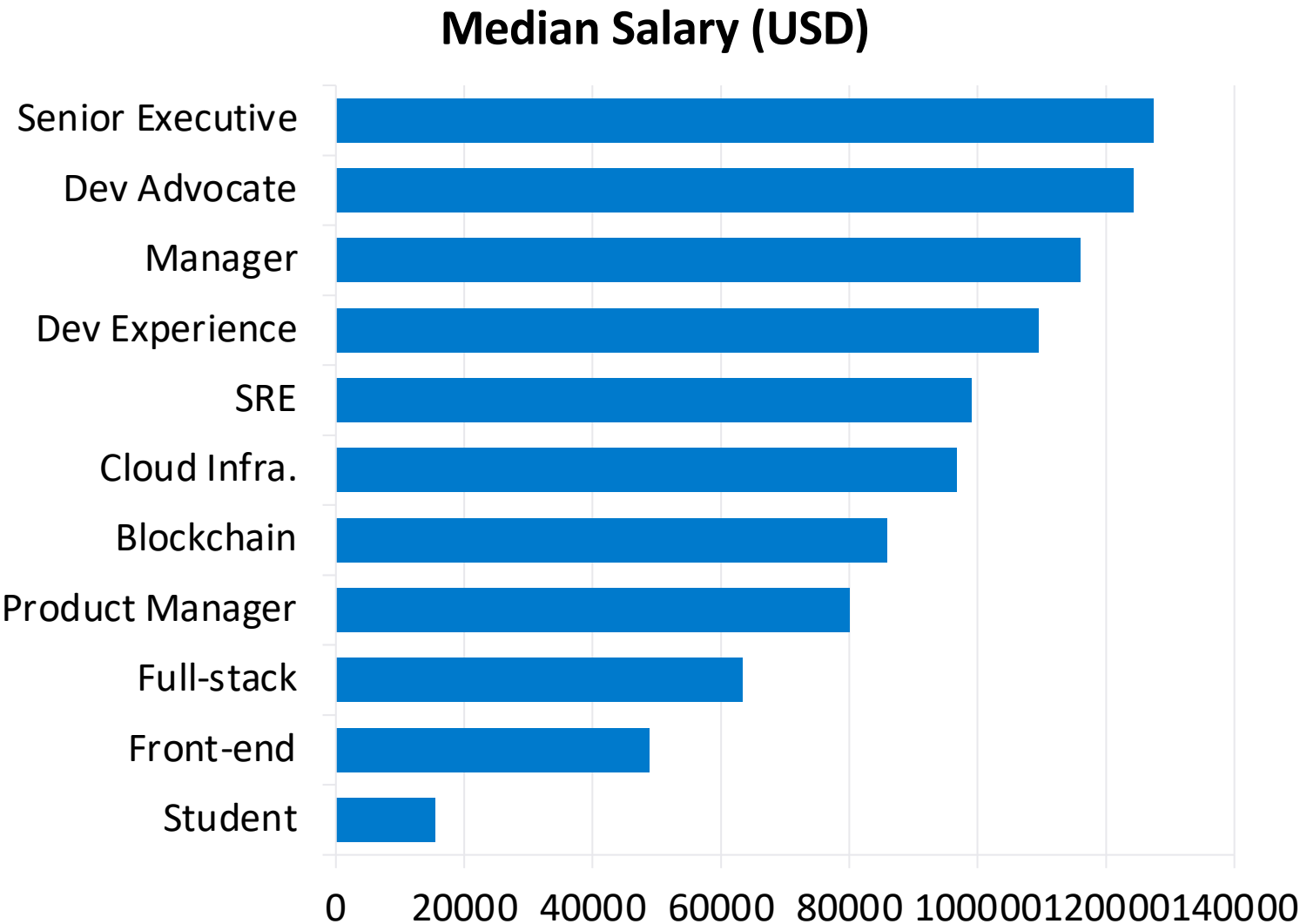
38% Remote

Significant share of workforce

20% In-person

Up from 15% in 2022 (+5 pp)

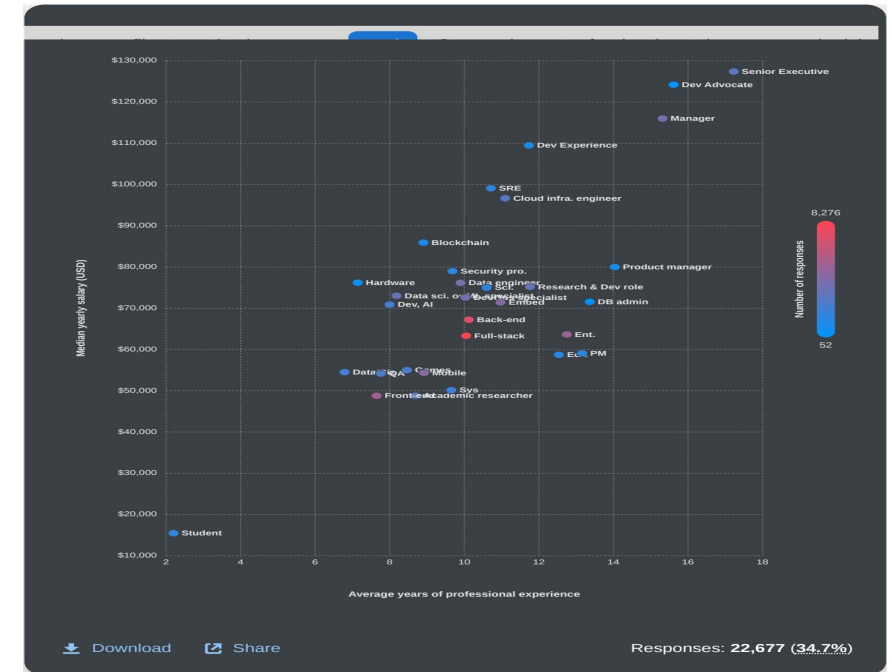
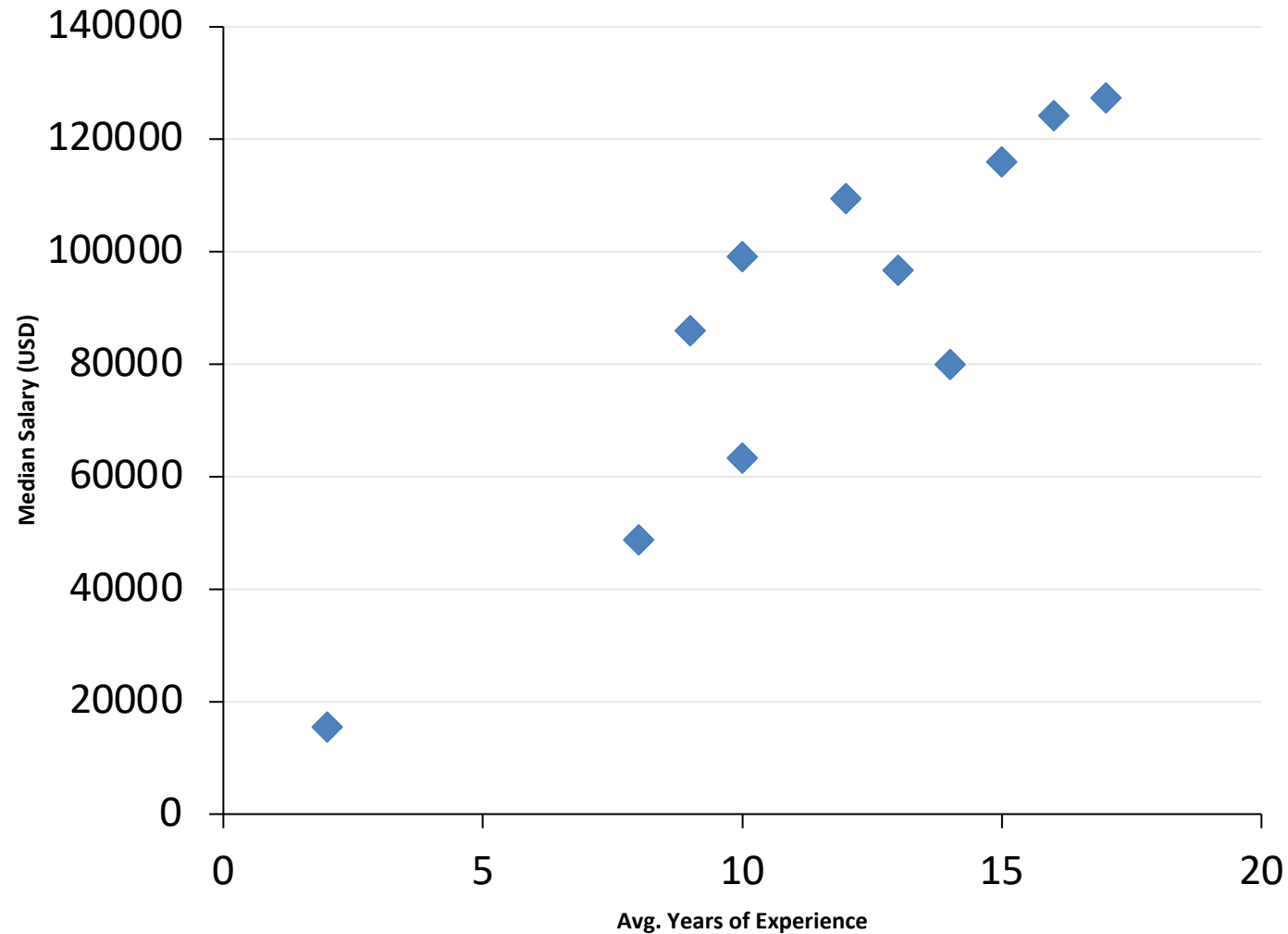
Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



22,677 salary responses (34.7% rate)
SRE & Cloud Infra. are highest-paid technical roles

Source: figure_1.jpg — Stack Overflow 2024

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Senior Exec: \$127K / 17 yrs

Dev Advocate: \$124K / 16 yrs

Manager: \$116K / 15 yrs

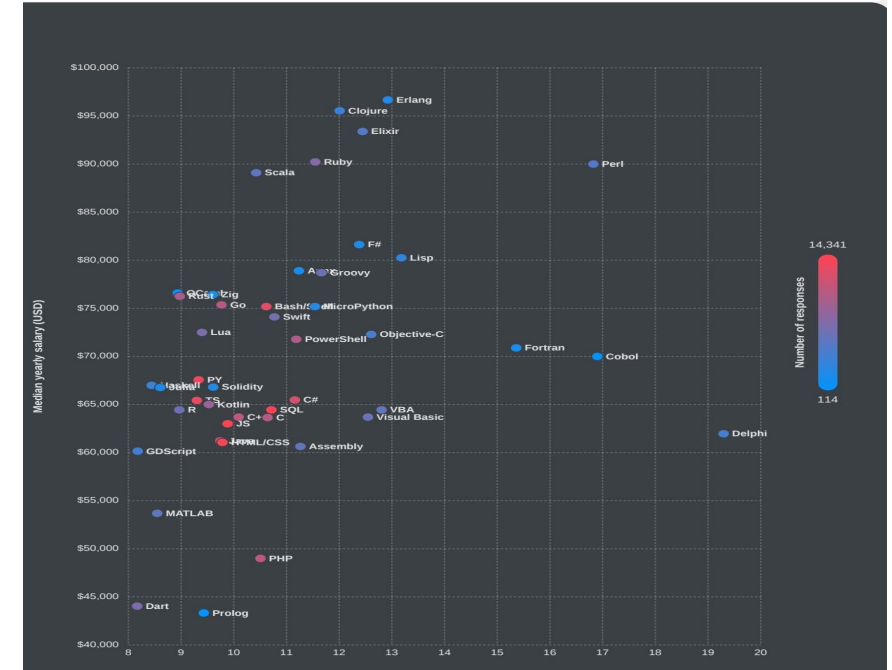
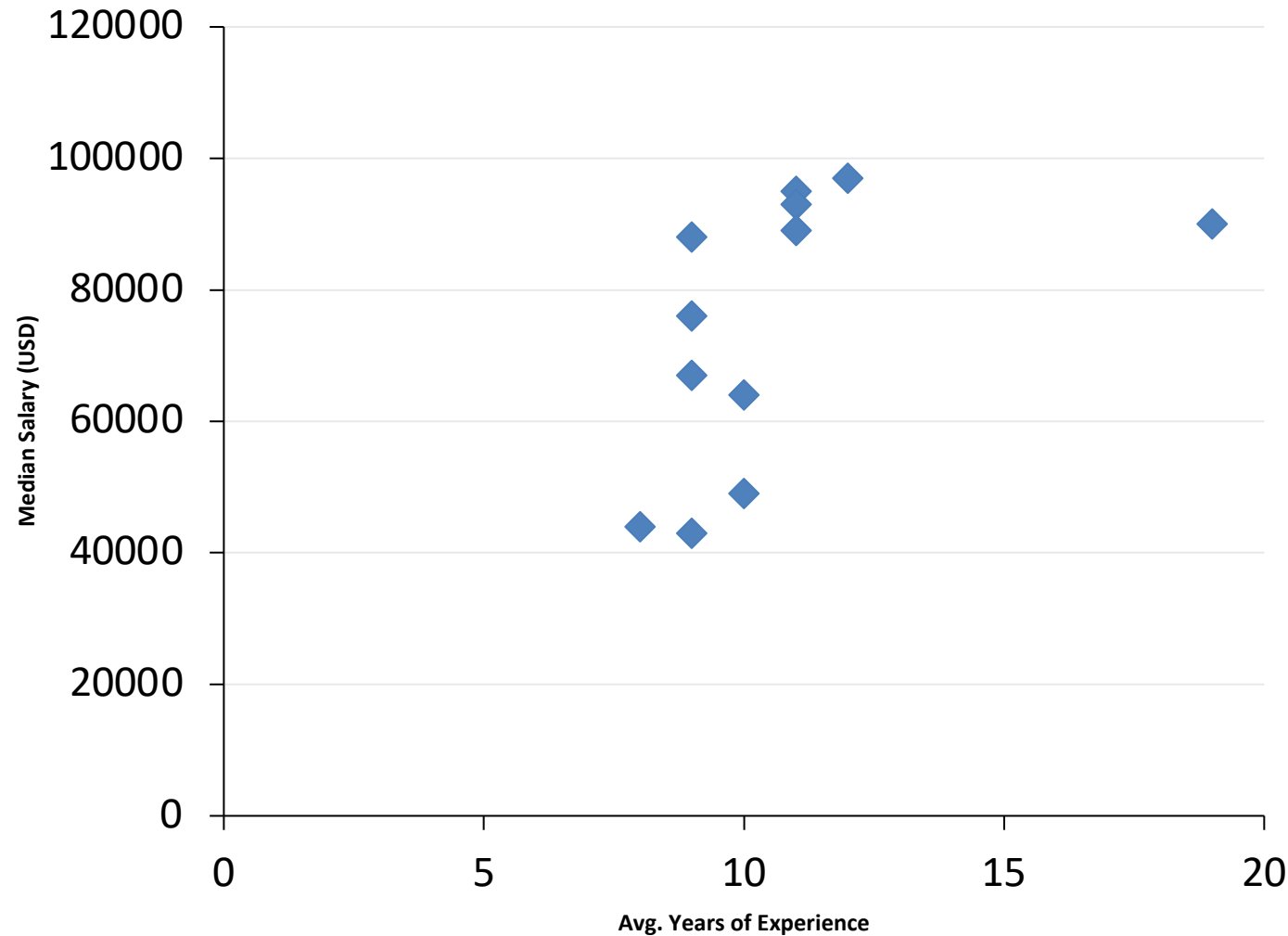
SRE: \$99K / 10 yrs

Cloud Infra.: \$97K / 13 yrs

Student: \$15K / 2 yrs

Source: figure_2.jpg — Stack Overflow 2024

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Niche functional languages pay more

Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (now \$60–75K avg. vs. \$70–85K). Erlang, Clojure & Elixir lead at >\$93K despite moderate experience.

Source: figure_3.jpg — Stack Overflow 2024

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution (n=42,827)



Technology Purchasing Influence

62%
of developers influence tech purchases

60%
prefer a build-and-buy approach

75%
start with a free trial to evaluate tools

73%
ask other developers for recommendations

Influence by role: Sr. Exec 99% | Eng. Mgr 87% | Product Mgr 77%

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1. Full-time employment is softening

U.S. full-time dropped 4 pp YoY. Plan for a growing share of freelancers and contractors in your talent mix.

2. In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates

In-person rose to 20% (from 15% in 2022), yet 42% hybrid shows flexibility remains a top employee expectation.

3. DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Senior Execs (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top the charts — budget accordingly for these critical roles.

4. Language choice correlates with compensation

Erlang, Clojure & Elixir devs earn >\$93K median. Mainstream JS/PHP sit below \$65K. Niche skills carry a premium.

5. Developers are key purchase influencers — engage them directly

62% influence tech buys; 75% start with free trials. Vendor strategies should target ICs, not just management.